



# Islamic Perspective on Peacebuilding & Non-Violence

## Definition: -

- Peace means *absence of war*. *Military definition*
- *‘Peace’ and ‘violence’ are linked. Peace is the absence of violence and should be used as the social goal.* – John Galtung

# Types:

*Like a coin, peace has two sides: negative peace and positive peace. Negative peace is the absence of personal violence; positive peace is an absence of structural violence or social justice. John Galtung*

- **Internal Peace:** Inner peace, psychological/spiritual peace
- **External Peace:**
  - **Positive Peace:**
    - a state of social harmony, social justice, social equality, friendship or friendly relation, public order and security, respect for human rights.
  - **Negative Peace:**
    - the absence of war, hostility, agitation, social disorder, disturbances, social injustice, social inequality, violence, violation of human rights, unrest, terrorism.

# Violence: Definition & Types

- *“an act of physical force that causes or is intended to cause harm. The damage inflicted by violence may be physical, psychological, or both”. (Brittanica)*
- **Direct/manifest violence**
  - Individual, state and non-state actors (political, religious, social, racial, gender-based)
- **Indirect/latent Violence**
  - Structural

# Islam & Peace:

- *“Whoever takes a life—unless as a punishment for murder or mischief in the land—it will be as if they killed all of humanity; and whoever saves a life, it will be as if they saved all of humanity.” (05:32)*
- *“if they (your enemies) keep away from you and cease their hostility and offer you peace, Allah bids you not to harm them”. (4:90)*
- *“If they (your enemies) incline to peace, make peace with them, and put your trust in Allah. Surely he is the hearing, the knowing.”. (8:61)*
- Defensive Nature of Jihad/Qital
- Prophetic tradition in treaties of Medinah, Hudaibiyah and conquest of Mecca.